

Delaware County Commissioners Meeting March 18th 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wEis9xDZjfA
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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: Monday, March 18, 2024

Recording Start Time: 00:06:03

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order:** The regular meeting of the Delaware County Commissioners was called to order by the presiding officer on Monday, March 18, 2024, at 00:06:03.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Commissioner Henry, Commissioner Reagan, and Commissioner Brooke (President/Presiding Officer).
 - **Absent:** None noted.

3. Procedural & Preliminary Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance 00:06:06. The board commended public safety officers and citizens who responded to the tragic tornado incident in Selma and Winchester.

- **Approval of Minutes:** Consideration of meeting minutes from February 5, February 20, and March 4 was tabled following a motion by Commissioner Brooke to allow additional time for review [00:26:50](#).
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved by Voice Vote to table the March 4th minutes ([00:28:52](#)).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Emergency Management & Disaster Declaration Updates [00:07:31](#)

- **Presenter:** John Cino, Emergency Management Director, alongside Mike Ashley (County EMS Director) and Commissioner Henry.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Officials delivered a comprehensive briefing on the severe weather and tornado that struck Selma on Thursday, March 14, 2024. The National Weather Service issued a tornado warning at 7:21 p.m., sirens sounded at 7:23 p.m., and the tornado touched down at 7:37 p.m. (providing a 14-minute advance warning). An Emergency Operations Center (EOC) was fully activated by 8:00 p.m. Preliminary damage reports for Selma include 6 destroyed structures, 13 major damages, 14 minor damages, 32 affected structures, and 58 hail damage reports. Delaware County also deployed extensive mutual aid, personnel (82 officers to Selma), and equipment (ambulances, transport buses, and strike teams) to assist neighboring Randolph County and Winchester.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously (Voice Vote) to adopt a local disaster declaration for the affected areas [00:25:50](#).

Board & Commission Appointments [00:26:07](#)

- **Item Identifier:** Visitors Bureau Appointment
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reappointment of Heidi Hail to the Visitors Bureau.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Henry: Yes, Reagan: Yes, King/Brooke: Yes) [00:26:20](#).

LPA Consulting Contract (Bridge 193) [00:29:03](#)

- **Item Identifier:** [00:29:03](#) LPA Consulting Contract for Bridge 193 Superstructure Replacement
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Highway / Engineering Staff
- **Deliberation Summary:** Standard INDOT boiler-plate contract for full-time construction inspection services for Bridge 193 on Memorial Drive over White River (letting in July). The contract amount is not to exceed \$514,000 with an 80% federal/state reimbursement, making the local match \$102,800. Staff confirmed that traffic will be maintained with at least one lane open in each direction during construction.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Henry: Yes, Reagan: Yes, King: Yes) [00:30:05](#).

Consulting Services Agreement [00:30:14](#)

- **Item Identifier:** [00:30:14](#) Agreement for Consulting Services (Chief Deputy Richmond)
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Carol / Commissioners
- **Deliberation Summary:** Agreement to retain outgoing Chief Deputy Richmond as a consultant at \$35 an hour to maintain operational continuity and data access.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Henry: Yes, Reagan: Yes, King: Yes) [00:30:57](#).

Ordinances for Approval

- [00:31:05](#) **Ordinance 2024-003: Comprehensive Zoning Ordinance Amendment (State Road 28 & Wheeling Ave)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Cheryl Dawson (Property Owner)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Rezoning the front field of a family farm parcel from business/mobile home park (set in the 1970s) back to farming to clean up farm parcels. Received a favorable recommendation from the plan commission.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (King: Yes, Reagan: Yes, Henry: Yes) [00:32:59](#).
- [00:33:08](#) **Ordinance 2024-004: Comprehensive Zoning Ordinance Amendment (Co. Rd. 500 East)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kathy Benice (Aston Land Surveying)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Rezoning a 1-acre platted lot (Lot 1) from R3 to farming to combine it with an adjacent parcel to the west to facilitate single-family home construction and access to County Road 500 East. Received a favorable recommendation.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (King: Yes, Reagan: Yes, Henry: Yes) [00:34:21](#).
- [00:34:29](#) **Ordinance 2024-005: Creation of New Grant Fund for Sheriff's Department Overtime (JAG Grant)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff's Department / Administration
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Establishes a new fund to receive and disburse JAG grant funding for department overtime.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Introduction: Approved by Roll Call Vote [00:35:09](#).
 - Suspension of Rules: Approved by Roll Call Vote [00:35:18](#).
 - Final Adoption: Approved by Roll Call Vote (King: Yes, Reagan: Yes, Henry: Yes) [00:35:28](#).

Resolutions for Approval

- **00:35:40 Resolution 2024-002: Emergency Declaration for Bridge 51 Repair**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Highway / Engineering Department
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Declares an emergency for the immediate repair of Bridge 51 (900 West / Muncie / 332), which developed a 4-foot diameter hole in the deck on March 9. The bridge will be repaired for passenger vehicles under a 3-ton load restriction while permanent rehabilitation is scheduled with the state for 2025/2026.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Henry: Yes, Reagan: Yes, King: Yes) **00:36:26**.
 - **00:40:32 Resolution 2024-003: Property Transfer to Nonprofit Entity (Muncie Land Bank)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A resolution identifying certain properties to be transferred to the Muncie Land Bank. Staff requested it be tabled because the attached property list required correction.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to table **00:41:21**.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:49:11 Pat Garolo** (Prevent Child Abuse Council): Spoke regarding April as National Child Abuse Prevention Month, highlighting the history and programs of the all-volunteer 501(c)(3) organization since 1995 (including the Child Advocacy Center, forensic exam rooms at the hospital, and awareness campaigns using blue pinwheels). Urged community members to report suspected child abuse to 1-800-555-5555.
 - **00:57:00 Fairboard Representative:** Announced that the Delaware County Fairgrounds will be open for camping and vendor events (coordinated by Moth Danner) Saturday through Monday during the April 8th solar eclipse.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Eclipse Planning & Building Closures:** Commissioners discussed extensive traffic, cell service congestion, and gridlock anticipated for the April 8th solar eclipse.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Passed Unanimously (Roll Call Vote: Henry: Yes, Reagan: Yes, King: Yes) to close the county building on Monday, April 8, 2024 **00:46:03**.
- **Payment of Claims:** Claims totaling \$782,103.34 were presented. Commissioner Henry raised questions regarding specific art claims.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved by Roll Call Vote (Henry: Yes, Reagan: Yes, King: Yes) subject to subsequent review by Commissioner Henry **00:48:23**.
- **Adjournment:** Entertained a motion to recess/adjourn **00:57:14**. Approved by Voice Vote.

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